CHILDCARE · ENGLAND ONLY

30 hours of childcare a week, paid by the government.

In England, for working parents: 30 hours a week, 38 weeks a year, from the term after the child turns 9 months. It does not arrive on its own — you have to apply.

WHAT YOU HAVE TO EARN

£203

You and your partner, if you have one, must each expect to earn at least £203.36 a week if you are 21 or over. That is the minimum wage for 16 hours a week.

> You apply online for a code, give it to the provider, then sign in every 3 months to reconfirm. If you stop qualifying, the place continues for a limited grace period.

WHO DOES NOT GET IT

£100,000

If you or your partner expects an adjusted net income over £100,000 this tax year, neither of you gets it. If you have no partner, only your own income is tested.

> And it is England only — Scotland, Wales and Northern Ireland run different schemes. The hours are free, but a provider may charge for meals, nappies or trips; they are not allowed to make those compulsory.

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The code comes from gov.uk, not from an accountant.

The conditions and the application are at gov.uk/free-childcare-if-working. For tax, payroll and dividends, message us.

0330 133 1886

General information, not benefits advice. The conditions are on GOV.UK.